

Sharif Power

MARCH 30, 2009

Former prime minister Nawaz Sharif emerges as the most powerful political player in Pakistan after winning a stand-off with President Asif Zardari. The hardest part is yet to come: Saving the country from collapse.



“The establishment in Pakistan, be it civil or military, democratic or dictatorial, has sown wild oats over the years. Let's hope good sense prevails and peace is restored.”

BISHAN SAHAI, via www.indiatoday.in

Trouble in Waiting

Even though most in Pakistan will acknowledge that democracy is the best form of governance, no one has the slightest idea what this means. Whoever comes to power is extremely insecure. No matter how wobbly a civilian government is, the army is certainly not a better alternative. The government must learn to stand on its own feet and resolve disputes through dialogue. The future of Pakistan lies in the hands of its people who can change its destiny and rescue it from the clutches of the Taliban. K.S. JAYATHEERTHA, via www.indiatoday.in

Thought Process

General Pervez Musharraf represents one of the wildest, not finest, minds in the



Kill Joy

Freshers in educational institutions across the country are assaulted and sexually abused by their seniors, right under the nose of the authorities who do nothing to prevent this brutal practice ("Ragged to Death", March 30). Instead, the authorities expect the harassed students to file complaints and seek redressal. They either suffer in silence or are compelled to end their lives. To save students like 19-year-old Aman Kachroo, educational institutions have to be more authoritative in implementing anti-ragging laws. K.L. VENKATRAMAN, via www.indiatoday.in

Since the Supreme Court's ruling to root out this "pernicious practice" has fallen on deaf ears, educational institutions which fail to curb this barbaric act should be deprived of any financial aid. Their affiliations should also be cancelled.

DR S.K. AGGARWAL, Amritsar

world ("Challenges of Change", March 23). To give an opportunity to such a person to spout his views before a national audience was disgusting. And while delivering his speech at the Conclave, he once again revealed his frozen mindset by referring to terrorists as freedom fighters, repeating that Kashmir was the core issue and levelling charges of Muslim alienation. He failed to rise to the occasion. Y.G. CHOUKSEY,

via www.indiatoday.in

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